

PRESS KIT · 2026 · SCI-FI · SHORT FILM · 14:17

KHARMA.

A FILM BY MARCELLO L. RASO

STAR WARS MEETS GAME OF THRONES.

A FOUR-QUADRANT SCI-FI SAGA FOR EVERY AUDIENCE

A broken space explorer, crushed by debt and haunted by the disappearance of his son, is forced into a mission beyond the edge of the known universe by the very enemy that took everything from him.

AWARD WINNER
Jeju International AI Film Festival
KOREA 2026

TOKYO FILM AND SCREENPLAY AWARDS
HONORABLE MENTION

OFFICIAL SELECTION
AI Film 3 - AI Film and Art Festival | Arizona | Year III
2026

FINALIST
Aphrodite Film Awards
2026 New York

OFFICIAL SELECTION
CSFCCA INTERNATIONAL AI FILM FESTIVAL
2026

OFFICIAL SELECTION
NeuroScope Films
2026

AWARD WINNER
JEJU AI INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL · KOREA

SCREENER · 4K
LINK ON PAGE 2

CONTACT
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THE FILM

FACT SHEET · CREDITS · SCREENER

01 · THE HOOK

STAR WARS MEETS GAME OF THRONES

The wonder and scale of a space saga, with the dynasties, power games and morally grey characters of a war for the throne.

02 · THE AUDIENCE

FOUR-QUADRANT

Built for everyone: men and women, younger and older viewers. At its heart is a story anyone understands: a father looking for his son.

03 · THE UNIVERSE

A WORLD BUILT TO LAST

The opening chapter of a series, backed by a complete bible of planets, dynasties, cults and hunters. WGA registered.

TITLE	KHARMA
GENRE	Science fiction · Epic
TYPE	Short film · opening chapter of the KHARMA series
RUNTIME	14 minutes 17 seconds
LANGUAGE	English
COUNTRY · YEAR	Italy · 2026
FORMAT	4K · 16:9 · Color · Stereo
IP	KHARMA Universe™ · WGA Registered

WRITTEN BY	Marcello L. Raso
DIRECTED BY	Marcello L. Raso
PRODUCED BY	Marcello L. Raso
MUSIC BY	Marcello L. Raso
EDIT · SOUND	Marcello L. Raso

SCREENER · 4K

WATCH KHARMA

youtube.com/watch?v=pl1MKsME1ZU

filmfreeway.com/projects/4319530

7
FESTIVALS · 2026

1st
ITALIAN WINNER · JEJU

4Q
FOUR-QUADRANT · ALL AUDIENCES

101
COUNTRIES IN COMPETITION · JEJU

II SYNOPSIS

THE STORY

One debt. One lost son. One mission beyond the edge of the known universe, for the very enemy that took everything from him.

KHARMA is a sci-fi opera where Star Wars meets Game of Thrones. In a distant future, humanity has discovered that it is not alone. Alien civilizations, ancient races and artificial intelligences coexist in a complex galaxy, where space exploration has opened up new opportunities... and new conflicts. In this fragile balance, knowledge of the universe is intertwined with mysterious cosmic energies, capable of interacting with space and time.

The exploration of unknown worlds is controlled by Discovery Interstellar Planet (DIP), but the best licenses are reserved for rich and noble elites who rarely undertake missions themselves, subcontracting the risks to low-level operators. It is in this world that we find Captain Biceky: a veteran space explorer, holder of a last-degree DIP license, crushed by debt and carrying a wound that never healed. His son was taken from him during a planetary attack years ago, and never found.

The story begins in the shadows of KHARMA, the capital planet of the known universe. The Twins, reptilian alien loan sharks originally from Kenter who now operate out of KHARMA, are looking for Biceky. He owes them everything. They find him where they always find him: at the casino, losing again. But instead of collecting the debt, they deliver him somewhere unexpected: the House of Vulsar.

Racheta, the iron-handed patriarch of the most powerful dynasty in the known universe, makes the Captain an offer that cannot be refused. His debt: erased. His DIP license: renewed. And something far more valuable: news of his missing son. In exchange, Biceky must travel beyond the Ereb Line, a region past the edge of the known universe that no chart has ever mapped, and bring back whatever he finds there. No questions asked.



THE LAST HAND CASINO DISTRICT



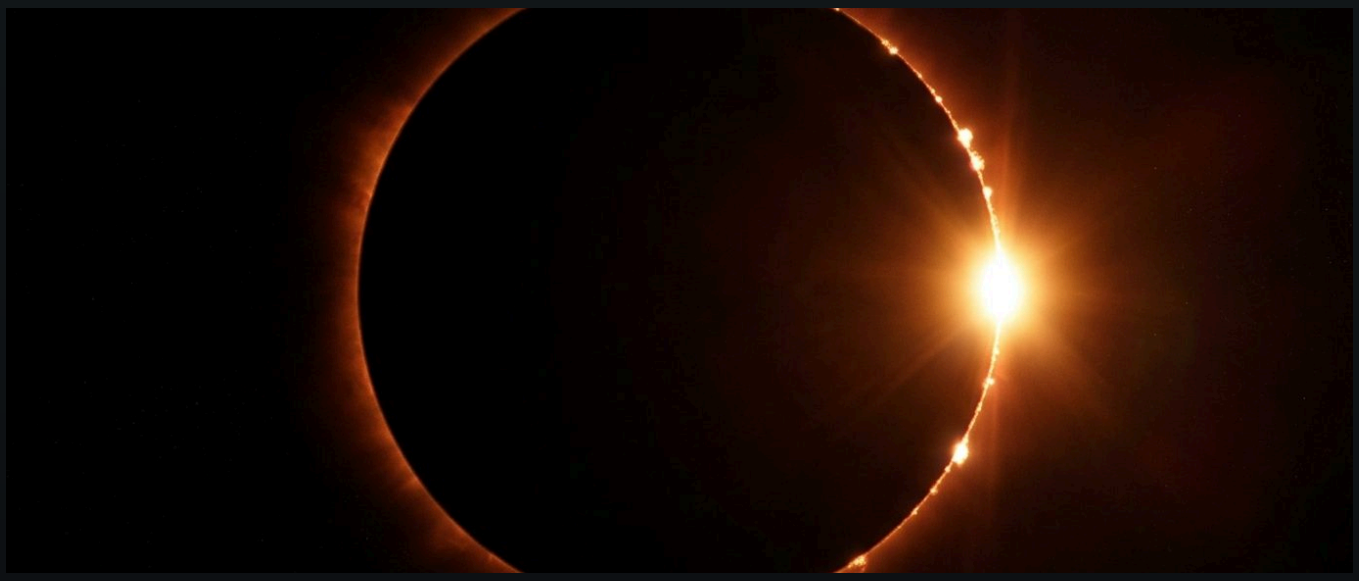
CAPTAIN BICEKY

The Captain has no choice. He never did. Together with Jack, his pilot, irreverent and fearless, he sets course for Planet DIP-X14, an uncharted frozen world at the edge of everything. What they find beneath the ice changes everything: a gigantic pyramid structure belonging to an unknown civilization, older than any recorded in history.

But they are not alone. The Manhunters, Alpha and Omega, lethal cybernetic hunters who answer to no one, have arrived on the same frozen world, drawn by the same coordinates. During a total eclipse, a portal opens in the ice. From beyond the known universe emerges a Sunwalker: an enigmatic entity, bearer of secrets linked to the cosmic energies that govern space and time.

What follows is a race against time across the frozen surface of DIP-X14. Jack manages to seize the Sunwalker's containment capsule before the Manhunters can secure it. He escapes across the frozen lake under a raging blizzard while Alpha and Omega cut down everything in their path. The Captain, waiting aboard the ship, hears Jack's voice crackle through the comms, and gives the only order that matters: received.

The retrieval of the Sunwalker will set in motion a chain of events destined to intertwine alien races, ancient powers, corporate guilds and artificial intelligences, in a universe where science, spirituality and power collide. For the Captain, the mission is only the beginning. Somewhere out there, beyond the Ereb Line, his son is still waiting.



TOTAL ECLIPSE · PLANET DIP-X14



ALPHA MANHUNTER IN THE BLIZZARD



THE DIP SHIP · DIP-X14

III FESTIVALS & AWARDS

KHARMA · 2026



WINNER	**JEJU AI INTERNATIONAL FILM FESTIVAL** Award Winner · Best in Category: Sci-Fi · selected from 1,185 submissions from 101 countries	JEJU ARTS CENTER JEJU · SOUTH KOREA
HONORABLE MENTION	**TOKYO FILM & SCREENPLAY AWARDS** Excellence in Screenwriting & Directing	TOKYO · JAPAN
FINALIST	**APHRODITE FILM AWARDS** Finalist · Best AI-Generated Work · 2026	NEW YORK · USA
SELECTION	**AIFILM3** Official Selection · theatrical screening	POLLACK TEMPE CINEMAS ARIZONA · USA
SELECTION	**CSFCCA INTERNATIONAL AI FILM FESTIVAL** Official Selection · Fall 2026	TAIPEI · TAIWAN
SELECTION	**NEUROSCOPE FILMS** Official Selection · 2026	USA

> The first Italian to win a film festival award in South Korea with a sci-fi film made using AI.

ALSO

EDUCATION	Case study of excellence in the Jeju festival's AI filmmaking programs
EXHIBITION	Theatrical screenings in Korea and the USA
INTERVIEW	Aphrodite Film Awards · “Direction first, AI second”
STREAMING	Shaike · YouTube
DIRECTOR	Shaike Certified Creator

IV DIRECTOR'S STATEMENT

DIRECTION FIRST, TECHNOLOGY SECOND

KHARMA is the opening chapter of a universe I have been building for a long time. For years the tools to make it real did not exist at a scale an independent filmmaker could reach. Now they do.

But KHARMA is not a film made by a machine. It is a directed film. Every shot started on the page: script, shot list, framing, lens, blocking and performance, written as a director's brief before a single frame was generated. AI was the crew that executed that brief: the set builders, the visual effects department, the cameras I could never have afforded. Every choice stayed mine.

The tone I aimed for is serious, layered and human, closer to Andor than to spectacle. A universe where no one is purely good or purely evil, where power is quiet and ruthless, and where the most important story is always a personal one. A father looking for his son. Everything else, the politics, the factions, the cosmic energies, is the world he has to survive to get there.

This film is the beginning. The universe is already built.

— MARCELLO L. RASO · DIRECTOR & SCREENWRITER

V THE METHOD

HOW KHARMA WAS MADE · FROM PAGE TO FINAL MIX

01 · PAGE
SCRIPT
Screenplay, series bible and shot list, written before anything is generated.

02 · SET
DIRECT
Every shot written as a director's brief: framing, lens, blocking, light and performance.

03 · LOOK
DESIGN
Characters, wardrobe, ships and worlds designed as references and locked for continuity.

04 · BUILD
AI
Shots built with AI, one by one, to the brief. AI executes; the director decides.

05 · FINISH
CUT & SCORE
Edit, sound design, voices, mix and original music.

PRODUCTION TOOLS

IMAGE & DESIGN	Midjourney · Nano Banana 2 · Nano Banana Pro
VIDEO	Seedance 2 · Kling Omni · Runway · Act-Two
VOICE	ElevenLabs
MUSIC	Original score · Suno
EDIT & POST	DaVinci Resolve

BEYOND KHARMA · THE HYBRID METHOD



In his newer work, scenes are first shot on a real set with actors, camera and light. Depth and motion are then extracted from the take and AI builds the world around the directed performance.

VI PRODUCTION STILLS

HIGH-RESOLUTION STILLS AVAILABLE ON REQUEST



THE DIP SHIP



THE HOUSE OF VULSAR



VULSAR GUARD



KHARMA · CAPITAL PLANET OF THE KNOWN UNIVERSE

VII THE DIRECTOR

MARCELLO L. RASO · DIRECTOR & SCREENWRITER



Marcello L. Raso is an award-winning Italian director and screenwriter and the creator of the KHARMA universe. He trained at the Centro Sperimentale di Cinematografia in Rome, in directing, actor direction, cinematography, screenwriting and production.

His sci-fi short KHARMA won Best Film at the Jeju AI International Film Festival in South Korea, making him the first Italian to win the festival with a sci-fi film made with the support of AI. KHARMA also received an Honorable Mention for Excellence in Screenwriting & Directing at the Tokyo Film & Screenplay Awards and was named a Finalist for Best AI-Generated Work at the Aphrodite Film Awards in New York. His horror short The Mirror Door received an Honorable Mention at Dreamina's worldwide Spooktacular Film Contest, awarded by a jury that included Chris White, executive producer of The Backrooms (A24).

His method: direction first, the story always at the center, and AI as the studio that expands what reaches the screen. He is an Official Creative Partner of Seedance, CapCut, Hailuo, OpenArt, YouArt and Runway, and a Shaike Certified Creator.

SELECTED WORK



KHARMA

Sci-fi · Short film · 2026



THE MIRROR DOOR

Horror · Short film · 2026 · Honorable Mention, Dreamina Spooktacular (jury incl. Chris White, The Backrooms)



PREDATOR ORIGINS

Action · Fan series · 2025–2026 · 100M+ views

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